

Deep Asia–London Session Study: 17 Years of NQ Futures



Deep Asia–London Session Study: 17 Years of Nasdaq Futures Data

By Herman Trading

Introduction

Understanding the relationship between the **Asia**, **Pre-London**, and **London** sessions provides valuable insight into how liquidity

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Data and Methodology

Data source: BacktestMarket.com

Instrument: Nasdaq Futures (NQ)

Sample size: 4,262 trading days (≈ 17 years)

Resolution: 1-minute OHLCV data

Timezone: Converted from Chicago Time (CT)
to New York Time (ET)

Weekends: Excluded (Monday–Friday only)

Each day was segmented into sessions based
on New York time:

- **Asia Session:** 20:00 – 00:00
- **Pre-London (Dead Zone):** 00:00 – 02:00
- **London Session:** 02:00 – 05:00

All timestamps were normalized to ensure
consistency across years and volatility regimes.

Session Definitions

To analyze liquidity interaction across sessions,
the script isolated each period as separate
dataframes using pandas:

This allowed for precise testing of how often
each session **swept** (broke) the Asia range's

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Pre-London / Dead Zone (00:00–02:00)

- Sweeps Asia High: **34.44%**
- Sweeps Asia Low: **27.29%**
- Sweeps Both High and Low: **1.74%**



Interpretation:

The Pre-London window rarely captures both sides of the Asia range.

It typically serves as a **liquidity-building phase**, often setting traps before the London session expands directionally.

London Session (02:00–05:00)

- Sweeps Asia High: **59.81%**

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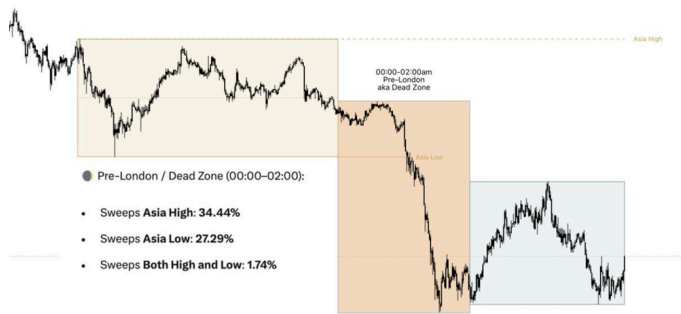
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The London Killzone shows a distinct increase in volatility and sweep activity.

Roughly **60%** of days break the Asia high, and **50%** take the Asia low.

Both sides are swept on nearly **18%** of all days — often leading to major reversals or strong directional days.

Combined Session (00:00–05:00)

- Sweeps Asia High: **65.32%**
- Sweeps Asia Low: **55.42%**

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When combining both Pre-London and London sessions, Asia highs are swept in nearly **two-thirds of all days**, confirming a consistent liquidity interaction before the New York open.

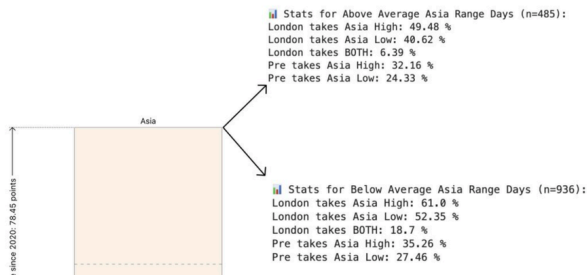
Average Asia Range and Volatility Context

The **average Asia session range** since 2020 measures **78.45 points** on NQ.

This 5-year window (2020–2025) better represents current market volatility than older data, as session amplitude has increased significantly since 2019.

This average was used as a dynamic threshold to divide all days into:

- **Above-average Asia Range Days**
- **Below-average Asia Range Days**



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On wider Asia ranges, London tends to be more selective, often sweeping just one side.

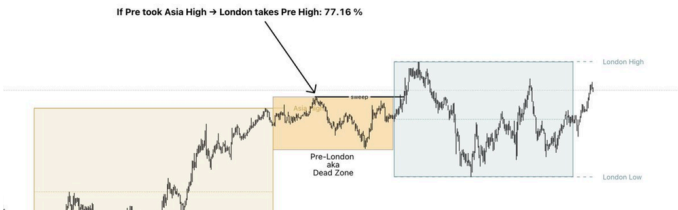
Category	London Takes Asia High	London Takes Asia Low	Takes Both	Pre Takes Asia High	Pre Takes Asia Low
Above-Average Range (n=485)	49.48%	40.62%	6.39%	32.16%	24.33%
Below-Average Range (n=936)	61.0%	52.35%	18.7%	35.26%	27.46%

Continuation Patterns: Pre-London → London

One of the most statistically significant findings is the **continuation effect** from Pre-London into London.

All Days (n=1421)

- If Pre took Asia High → London takes same high again: **77.16%**
- If Pre took Asia Low → London takes same low again: **69.60%**



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that Pre-London often sets the stage for the London expansion.

Day Close Behavior After Sweeps

This confirms a mild bullish bias after London takes the Asia high, while Asia-low sweeps show modest continuation to the downside.

Although not extreme, these probabilities support bias confirmation into the **New York session**.

Day Close Behavior After Sweeps		
Event	Day Closed Higher	Day Closed Lower
London took Asia High	60.81%	39.19%
London took Asia Low	48.10%	51.90%
Pre took Asia High	57.22%	42.78%
Pre took Asia Low	53.14%	46.86%

Practical Takeaways for Traders

1. Directional Bias from Liquidity Sweep

If London sweeps Asia High → expect higher close bias (≈60%).

If London sweeps Asia Low → expect

continuation probability.

Wide Asia ranges → lower odds of follow-through; more traps and range-bound behavior.

4. Avoid Overtrading During Dead Zone

The Pre-London session sweeps both Asia highs and lows only **1.13%** of the time.

Focus on observation and liquidity mapping rather than aggressive entries.



Conclusion

Across 17 years of Nasdaq Futures data, the **Asia-London interaction** consistently reveals

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NQ London Playbook —
Decision Tree (with stats)

Historical Sweep + Return to
Open Study on 1H Candles
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